

we should postpone it because there was already an issue with the UGC-NET and for the NEET-UG too. So, we decided not to do things in haste and deferred the exam.

Q. When it comes to the NEET, reports are coming in that possibly the question paper has also been leaked from one or two centres. Since you cancelled the UGC-NET because of a paper leak, has it now become imperative that NEET be cancelled too?

These are two different things. The UGC-NET question paper had leaked on the electronic medium. In NEET, apparently it is a localised, isolated issue, which is being investigated. Primarily, Bihar as well as Gujarat police have been proactive and are ring-fencing both. In the inquiry, they have identified how far it has spread. In due process, all candidates have been served show cause notices on why they will not be debarred in the future from this type of examination. That legal process has been done. In the country, these subjects are under the purview of the Supreme Court. The court will take a holistic view on July 8. We have to wait for it.

Q. What is the other reason?

Secondly, meritorious students across the country who have studied hard have a strong viewpoint. They want to move ahead and study, and their interest is important. As a government, our responsibility is towards everyone, and we should work with great sensitivity. We have to work on concrete proof and information, which the government has done. People had resentment against the NTA. We also prima facie thought so. So, we changed the NTA's leadership. A senior-most, secretary-level person has been made its director-general. To let it not spread, considering the whole examination process, data pooling, the structure of NTA and other issues, we have formed a high-level committee headed by former ISRO chairman Dr K. Radhakrishnan, with other experts as members. In this whole episode, in the isolated incidents that happened in two-three places, what was the submission of the people who moved writ petitions? That there should be a neutral inquiry. And we ordered a CBI inquiry. In all these, the government is committed to zero error.

> **"My responsibility is not to create anxiety in examinees. The Opposition will play their role. The conscience of the government is clear. We've done everything to fix this"**

Q. So, you don't see the need to cancel NEET?

Forty-six writ petitions were filed and the whole episode is before the court. The matter is sub judice, it's unfair on my part to spell out anything. Let the court take (a decision). The NTA did not have any tradition or practice or rules to give grace marks. By giving 1,563 students grace marks, the NTA set a wrong precedent. Then people went to the court. The court said the government should look into it. The NTA submitted a proposal for re-examination before the court, and the court endorsed it. Re-examination happened for these 1,563 students on June 23. The court hasn't yet cancelled counselling. Whatever responsibility the government had, we have done it. It would be prudent to wait for the court's ruling.

Q. The Opposition has been demanding your resignation because clearly these flaws are serious and students have been affected. Your reaction?

During the Opposition's time, when there was a Congress government in Rajasthan, were there no question paper leaks? I don't want to speak in political language in this whole episode. My responsibility is not to create anxiety in the minds of those who have appeared in the exams or want to take them. The Opposition has a role to play, they will play their role. My conscience is clear. The conscience of my government is also clear. We have left no stone unturned to fix this.

Q. There are Computer-Based Tests (CBT) like the JEE (Joint Entrance Examination for engineering). There was talk of NEET going for CBT in 2018. Do you think it's time to review this?

Look, there are both practices—CBT and pen and paper. Currently, the capacity of our country to conduct Computer Based Testing is around three lakh. We have to do six sittings for it. There are challenges there. We do it in JEE. In that,